IEEE GUB Student Branch

Green University of Bangladesh

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Report Name : IEEE WIE Session

Header

The IEEE GUB Student Branch, Green University of Bangladesh, organised a Women in Engineering (WIE) session, co-organised by the IEEE Computer Society GUB Student Branch Chapter and the IEEE Power and Energy Society (IEEE PES) GUB Student Branch Chapter, featuring a keynote address by Prof. Dr. Celia Shahnaz. The session highlighted IEEE's professional opportunities, Women in Engineering initiatives, research and innovation, and collaboration in solving real-world challenges. It brought together university authorities, faculty members, IEEE representatives, student leaders, and participants to explore professional development, mentorship, and technological advancement, emphasising inclusive innovation and the development of solutions that benefit society.

Description

The WIE session featured a keynote address by Prof. Dr. Celia Shahnaz, who discussed the professional opportunities offered by IEEE and the role of Women in Engineering in promoting collaboration, research, and innovation. She shared insights into her involvement in establishing IEEE WIE initiatives in Bangladesh in 2010 and reflected on the subsequent growth of WIE activities across the country. She noted that Bangladesh has approximately 24 WIE branches and highlighted the international recognition received by the Bangladesh WIE community in 2017. Her address demonstrated the importance of sustained initiatives in expanding opportunities for women engineers and encouraging greater participation in the engineering and technology sectors.

A major focus of her speech was the importance of collaboration and collective effort in achieving meaningful progress. She explained that time and resources are limited, making it essential for individuals and organisations to work together rather than create unnecessary divisions. To illustrate the principles of effective collaboration, she highlighted four key values: Collaboration, Discussion, Transparency, and Integration. Collaboration involves working together towards shared objectives; Discussion encourages the exchange of ideas, knowledge, and experiences; Transparency promotes openness and accountability; and Integration brings together diverse expertise, resources, and efforts to achieve common goals. She encouraged students to apply these principles in their academic activities, research initiatives, and professional relationships.

The keynote address also emphasised the importance of using IEEE's resources and professional networks to identify opportunities for collaboration. Prof. Dr. Celia Shahnaz encouraged students to engage with the wider IEEE community, participate in technical activities, and develop projects that address genuine societal and technological challenges. She highlighted that research papers, technical projects, and innovative solutions are important for building a strong professional identity within IEEE. Rather than focusing solely on participation, students were encouraged to produce meaningful work that demonstrates their technical capabilities, originality, and commitment to innovation.

Another important aspect of the session was the role of inclusive technology in improving people's lives. The speaker shared examples of technology-related initiatives, including sign-language projects designed to support people with disabilities. These examples illustrated how engineering and innovation can contribute to accessibility, inclusion, and social well-being. She also discussed technical competitions and innovation challenges as opportunities for students to develop practical skills, exchange ideas, and transform their knowledge into effective solutions. Her message encouraged participants to view technology not merely as a technical pursuit but as a means of addressing real-world needs.

At approximately 3:48 PM, the Honorable Vice-Chancellor arrived at the venue while the keynote session was in progress. In his address, he expressed appreciation for Prof. Dr. Celia Shahnaz's contributions and encouraged students to learn from her experience, achievements, and leadership. He highlighted the value of mentorship in supporting students' academic and professional development and expressed interest in establishing an active mentorship programme connecting students with academics, professionals, and researchers. Such an initiative would help students gain guidance, develop their skills, and explore opportunities for research and career advancement.

The Honorable Vice-Chancellor also emphasised that IEEE works for the benefit of humanity and that technological development should be directed towards solving real-world problems. He encouraged students to bring creativity, originality, and practical implementation into their projects, stressing the importance of moving beyond theoretical ideas towards solutions that create tangible benefits. He further reaffirmed the university's support for student-led technological initiatives and research activities, encouraging students to pursue innovation and make productive use of the opportunities available to them.

The session concluded with closing remarks by Kabir Sir, who expressed gratitude to the distinguished guests, organisers, committee members, volunteers, and students for their participation and contributions. His remarks acknowledged the collective efforts that supported the programme and reinforced the importance of continued engagement in IEEE activities, professional development, and collaborative learning.

Overall, the WIE session provided valuable insights into professional opportunities within IEEE, the development of Women in Engineering initiatives, and the role of research, mentorship, and collaboration in advancing technical excellence. It encouraged students to strengthen their professional identities through research papers, technical projects, and practical innovation while promoting transparency, unity, and inclusive problem-solving. The discussion also reinforced the importance of developing technologies that respond to societal needs and contribute meaningfully to humanity.

Footer

The WIE session highlighted the importance of collaboration, research, innovation, mentorship, and professional development. Through keynote insights and the Vice-Chancellor's remarks, participants were encouraged to utilise IEEE resources, pursue technical projects, and develop solutions to real-world

challenges. The IEEE GUB Student Branch reaffirmed its commitment to promoting Women in Engineering, empowering students, and fostering inclusive innovation for the benefit of society and humanity.

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